

IT PROJECT MANAGEMENT

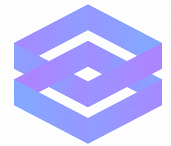
BLACKSTONE BEACON ERP SYSTEM

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COMPANY BACKGROUND

Blackstone Inc. is one of the world's leading investment firms, founded in 1985 and headquartered in New York City. The company operates globally with offices in London, Hong Kong, Beijing, and Abu Dhabi.





Blackstone Inc.

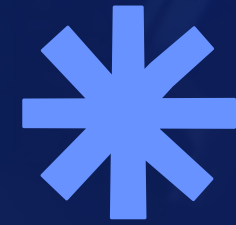


Blackstone invests across multiple industries, including:



Different offices relied on separate Excel spreadsheets and email communication, which created operational inefficiencies and limited collaboration between teams.

- **PRIVATE EQUITY**
- **TECHNOLOGY**
- **ENERGY**
- **RETAIL**



PROBLEM STATEMENT

- **EXISTING BUSINESS PROBLEMS**
- **GEOGRAPHIC SILOS**
- **METHODOLOGICAL RISK**
- **OPERATIONAL INEFFICIENCY**

The company's main problem was the overreliance on disconnected Excel spreadsheets and manual workflows. Different offices worked independently, which caused duplication of effort and poor collaboration. In addition, outdated spreadsheet models increased the risk of valuation mistakes, while analysts spent too much time on repetitive manual tasks instead of strategic financial analysis.

CASE OVERVIEW



BlackStone Inc. is a global investment firm with offices across major financial centers such as New York, London, and Hong Kong. Despite its scale, the company relies heavily on fragmented Excel spreadsheets and email communication to manage investment analysis and deal flow.

This creates duplication of work between offices and increases the risk of inconsistent or outdated data. It also leads to inefficiencies in decision-making and potential valuation errors. To solve this problem, a centralized system ("BlackStone Beacon") is proposed to unify data and automate key investment processes.

PROPOSED IT SOLUTION



To address inefficiencies in BlackStone's current workflow, a centralized digital platform called "BlackStone Beacon" is proposed. The system will serve as a single source of truth for all financial and investment data across global offices.



SMART OBJECTIVES

The project objectives are defined using the SMART framework to ensure clarity and measurability.

The system aims to deploy key modules such as Strategic Valuation and Portfolio Analytics to more than 50 analysts across global offices. It will reduce the time required to generate a standardized deal memo from 4 hours to 1 hour. The solution is designed to be achievable by using existing MySQL infrastructure and Python-based development within the current IT budget. It is relevant to BlackStone's goal of improving transparency and data-driven decision-making. The full transition to the "Beacon-first" system is planned to be completed by Q4 2026.



WORK BREAKDOWN STRUCTURE

The project is divided into five main phases, starting with planning and governance, followed by system design and architecture. The third phase focuses on developing the MVP with core system functionalities such as CRUD operations and dashboards. The fourth phase includes data migration and quality assurance through testing and validation. The final phase covers deployment, training, and project closure to ensure successful implementation and adoption.



PRODUCT BACKLOG

Priority	Feature	Purpose
P0	Secure Login	Protect sensitive financial data
P0	Enterprise Value Calculator	Automate valuation process
P0	Centralized Dashboard	Monitor global investment pipeline
P1	Update/Delete Functions	Maintain accurate deal records
P2	EBITDA Charts	Visualize company exposure
P3	PDF Export	Generate Investment Committee memos

RISK MANAGEMENT

Risk	Impact	Mitigation Strategy
Resistance to new system (“Excel Bias”)	Employees continue using spreadsheets	Staff training and mandatory system usage
Data migration errors	Incorrect financial information	Dual-validation with old Excel models
Security breach	Exposure of sensitive deal data	MFA and strict access permissions
Scope creep	Delays and budget overruns	Move extra features to Phase 2

PROJECT RESULTS & CONCLUSION

The BlackStone Beacon project successfully transformed fragmented Excel-based operations into a centralized cloud-based system. The platform reduced deal memo preparation time from 4 hours to 1 hour and improved collaboration between global offices.

The project also delivered a functional CRUD system connected to a MySQL database, improving data accuracy and operational transparency. Overall, the solution increased efficiency, reduced financial risks, and supported faster investment decision-making across the company.